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how many people use private medical services in the uk 2025

There isn't a single exact number for "people using private medical services" in the UK in 2025, because it depends on **how you define "use"** (insurance coverage vs actual treatment vs occasional use). But the best available 2024–2026 data gives a clear picture:

1) People with private medical insurance (core measure)

- About **7.6 million UK adults** had private medical insurance (PMI) in 2024 (**~14% of adults**)

The Actuary ⁺¹

- Including dependants (family members covered), around **~8 million people total** can access private care through insurance The Guardian

👉 This is the most commonly cited "regular users" group.

2) People actually using private healthcare (broader measure)

- Around **15% of Britons (≈1 in 7)** used private healthcare in the **previous year** YouGov
- Over a lifetime, **about one-third of people** in the UK have used private healthcare at some point

Independent Heal...

👉 This includes:

- Insurance-funded treatment
- Self-pay (paying directly for procedures, scans, etc.)

3) Very broad estimates (any form of private access)

- Some analyses suggest **~16 million people (≈1 in 4)** have access to or use some form of private healthcare (including insurance schemes, employer cover, or occasional use) The Times

✓ Simple summary

- **~7–8 million** → regularly covered by private insurance
- **~10 million+ per year (approx)** → use private services in a given year (based on ~15%)
- **~16 million (upper estimate)** → have some access or use at some level
- **~1 in 3 people** → have used it at least once in their lives

If you want, I can break it down further (e.g. NHS vs private usage trends, or why demand has risen recently).